(Indians and Chinese are brothers), they would protest his return with shouts of *Zhou Enlai hai-hai* (down with Zhou). Nehru would not go as far, but instead would instruct officials that there was no need to host a public reception for Zhou of the kind that had greeted him in the past and that had feted Eisenhower just a few months before.[43]

First, signs of trouble appeared on the frontier question. Zhou asserted in a letter to Nehru in January 1959 that China neither accepted the McMahon Line in the eastern sector nor withdrew its claim to Aksai Chin in the western one. He stated that the border had never been delimited formally and, in turn, complained about Indian maps. Nehru's reply in March 1959 laid out the basis of India's border claims. Furthermore, it suggested a return to the status quo ante, calling for the two countries to give up recently claimed spots.

Even as Indian officials had been drafting that reply, trouble appeared on another front. On March 10, a Tibetan uprising broke out in Lhasa after rumors that Beijing was going to arrest the Dalai Lama or forcibly remove him from Lhasa. As the situation deteriorated, the Indian government tried to deter rebel fighters from entering India. On March 19 the Indian government, however, sent a message to its consul general in Lhasa that it would give the Dalai Lama asylum if he asked for it. The Dalai Lama had already left Lhasa at that point and subsequently crossed over into India. Soon, he would be joined by thousands of refugees.

Nehru wanted to help the Tibetans, maintain China's friendship, and ensure Indian security—all while trying to prevent Tibet from becoming a Cold War issue and even more of a public issue in India. Parliamentary pressure had already led the government to allow an increasing number of refugees to enter. Very soon it would become clear that Nehru had failed on at least one front: maintaining the friendship with China. Initially, Beijing called Kalimpong, an Indian town close to the Sikkim border, the "commanding center" of the rebellion. Then, there were reports that members of the National People's Congress were accusing India of everything from kidnapping the Dalai Lama to encouraging the rebellion to interfering in Chinese affairs.

Nehru tried to reassure China about Indian intentions, and his government advised the Dalai Lama and his aides to steer clear of political statements or actions that might provoke Beijing further. The inflamed